

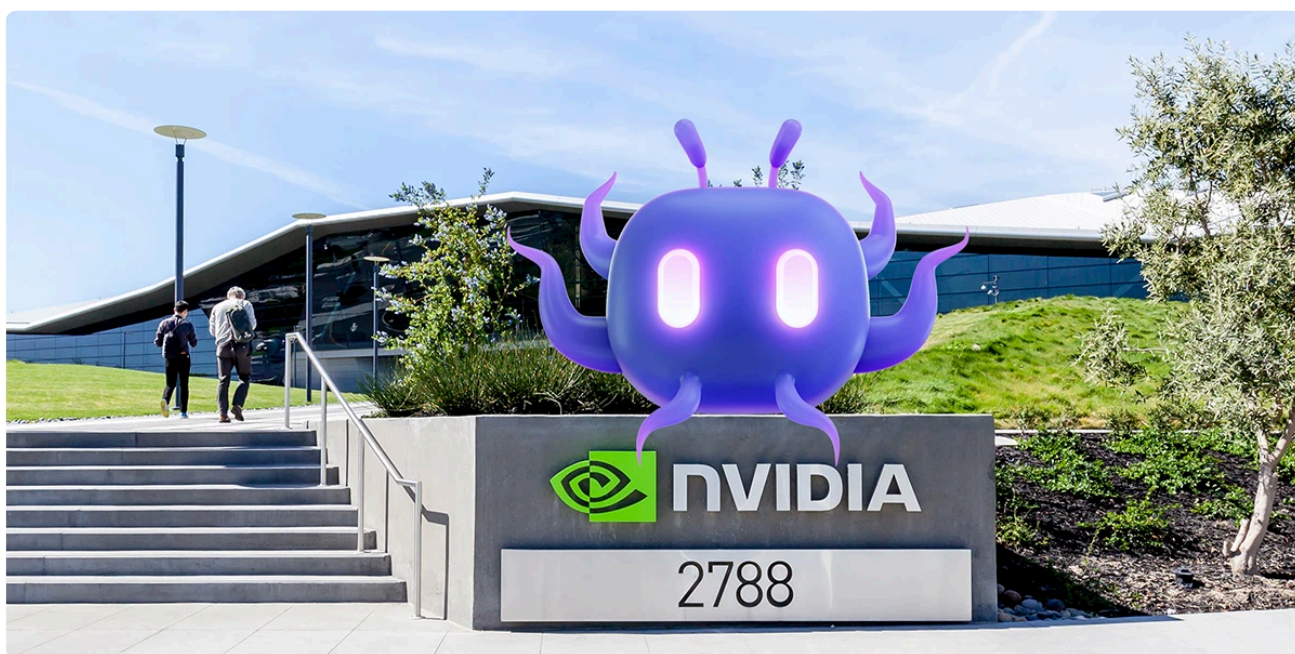


ПОДРОБНО

Автор: Глен Оллсопп | [in](#) 11,7 тыс. [🐦](#) 40,7 тыс.

Как стартапы и цифровые гиганты используют ИИ для увеличения трафика и прибыли

Делимся рабочими процессами, которые вы можете попробовать внедрить в своем бизнесе



По иронии судьбы, при создании этой графики ✨ искусственный интеллект не использовался. Только Photoshop

В ТОМ ЧИСЛЕ

[campus](#)

[theSkimm'](#)

[Sourcetable](#)

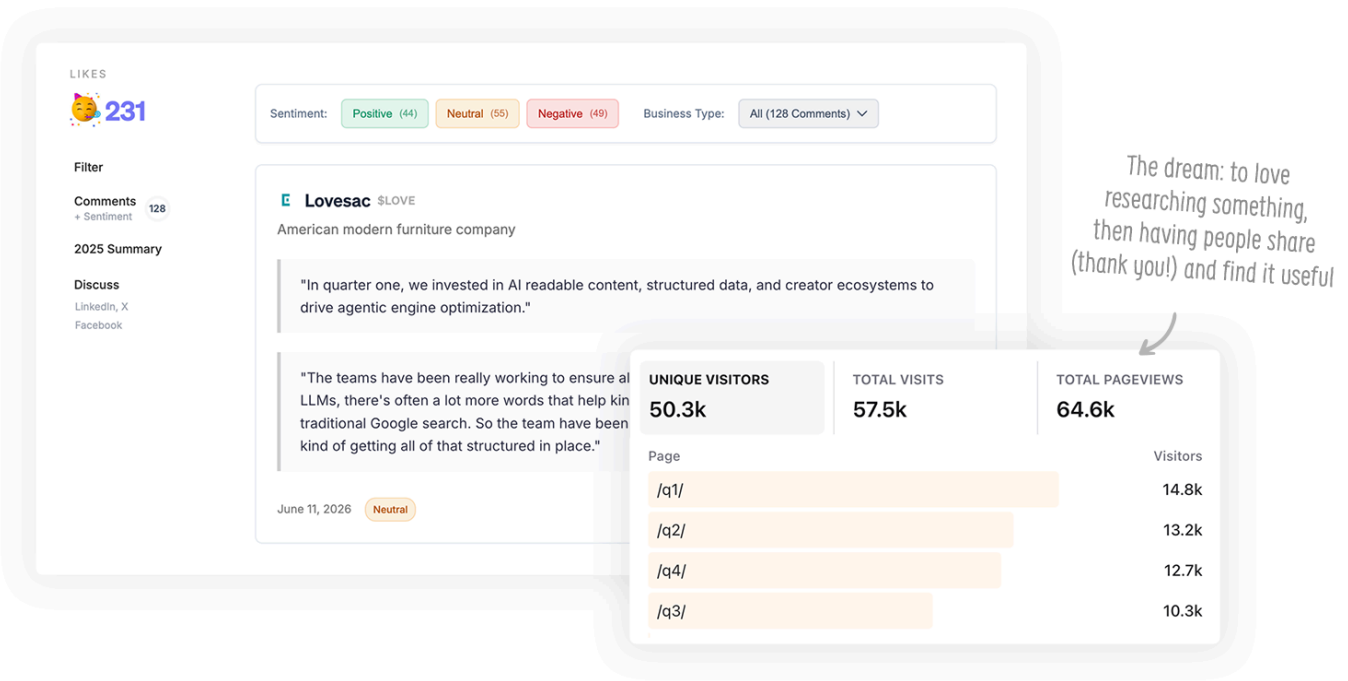
Добро пожаловать в первый выпуск **Deployed**.

Новая серия, в которой рассказывается о том, как стартапы, цифровые гиганты и компании всех типов внедряют искусственный интеллект для повышения конверсии, вовлеченности, трафика и прибыли.

Внимательные читатели, возможно, помнят другую мою серию — ежеквартальное обновление, посвященное SEO-стратегии крупных брендов.

Это было воспринято гораздо лучше, чем я мог себе представить, но из-за темпа работы мне иногда приходилось ждать месяцами, чтобы поделиться какой-нибудь важной идеей, из-за чего некоторые обновления оказывались слишком «старыми» для публикации.

Я частично решил эту проблему с помощью нашей регулярно обновляемой базы данных с цитатами публичных компаний по SEO (на фото ниже), но мне хочется вернуться к этой идее и обновлять ее чаще.



Исходные отчеты получили много положительных отзывов (за что я *искренне* благодарен), но другой подход был более логичным

Я по-прежнему увлечен поиском (и поиском с помощью искусственного интеллекта), но я также вижу массу возможностей для использования ИИ в маркетинге, которых раньше просто не существовало.

Я стараюсь писать такие отчеты, которые мне самой было бы интересно читать, и искренне надеюсь, что это первое издание будет вам полезно (потому что, если честно, я бы хотела писать больше таких отчетов).

#1

Opendoor сэкономил 500 тысяч долларов с помощью одного навыка Claude, но я должна честно сказать, чем могу и не могу поделиться

Есть много рабочих процессов с использованием ИИ, о которых я хотела бы узнать больше, но нет таких файлов навыков, которые я бы предпочла конкретному файлу от Opendoor.

В мае генеральный директор Каз Нетаджан вызвал у меня интерес, сказав следующее:



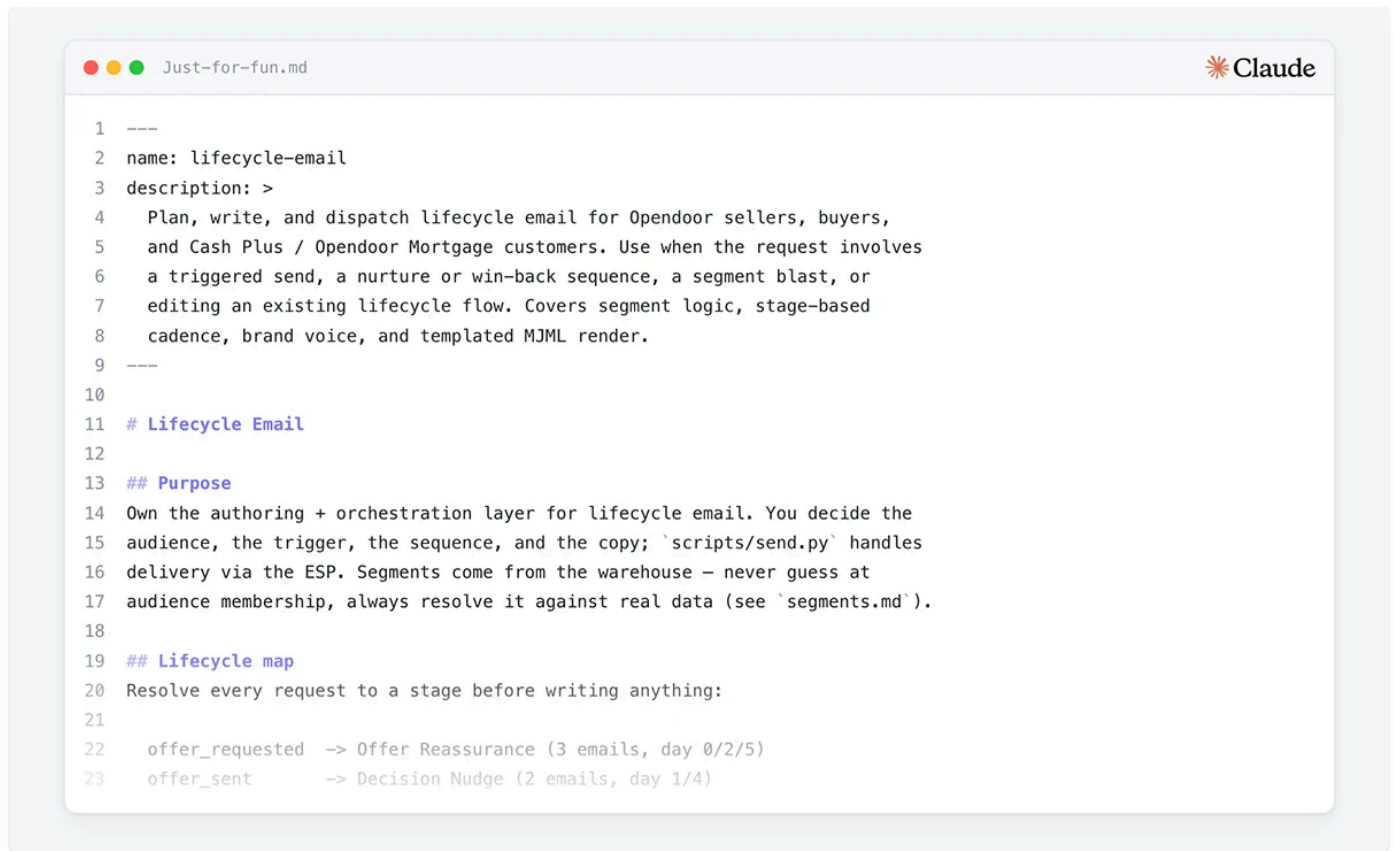
Один из наших менеджеров по маркетингу заменил нашу устаревшую систему электронной почты стоимостью 0,5 миллиона долларов на один из навыков Claude.

Скорее всего, это не имеет никакого отношения к тому, над чем я работаю, но я не могу отрицать, что мне невероятно любопытно, что там внутри.

Я связался с Казом, но, к сожалению, не получил ответа.

(Я бы не удивился, если бы он даже не увидел сообщение, так что, конечно, без обид.)

This report is human-written, but just for fun I prompted Opus 4.8 with nothing more than the above quote and background on Opendoor to muse on what the Skill file might cover:



```
1 ---
2 name: lifecycle-email
3 description: >
4   Plan, write, and dispatch lifecycle email for Opendoor sellers, buyers,
5   and Cash Plus / Opendoor Mortgage customers. Use when the request involves
6   a triggered send, a nurture or win-back sequence, a segment blast, or
7   editing an existing lifecycle flow. Covers segment logic, stage-based
8   cadence, brand voice, and templated MJML render.
9 ---
10
11 # Lifecycle Email
12
13 ## Purpose
14 Own the authoring + orchestration layer for lifecycle email. You decide the
15 audience, the trigger, the sequence, and the copy; `scripts/send.py` handles
16 delivery via the ESP. Segments come from the warehouse – never guess at
17 audience membership, always resolve it against real data (see `segments.md`).
18
19 ## Lifecycle map
20 Resolve every request to a stage before writing anything:
21
22 offer_requested  -> Offer Reassurance (3 emails, day 0/2/5)
23 offer_sent       -> Decision Nudge (2 emails, day 1/4)
```

I included this example to both introduce my goal for this report and clarify what I'm unable to share.

My aim is to provide inspiration for countless projects you can build to grow your own business, but we're unlikely to get the *exact* mechanics behind how companies implemented their version.

For those who need them, I'm working on a free video series to show how to build these solutions, but we'll have to take our own approach.

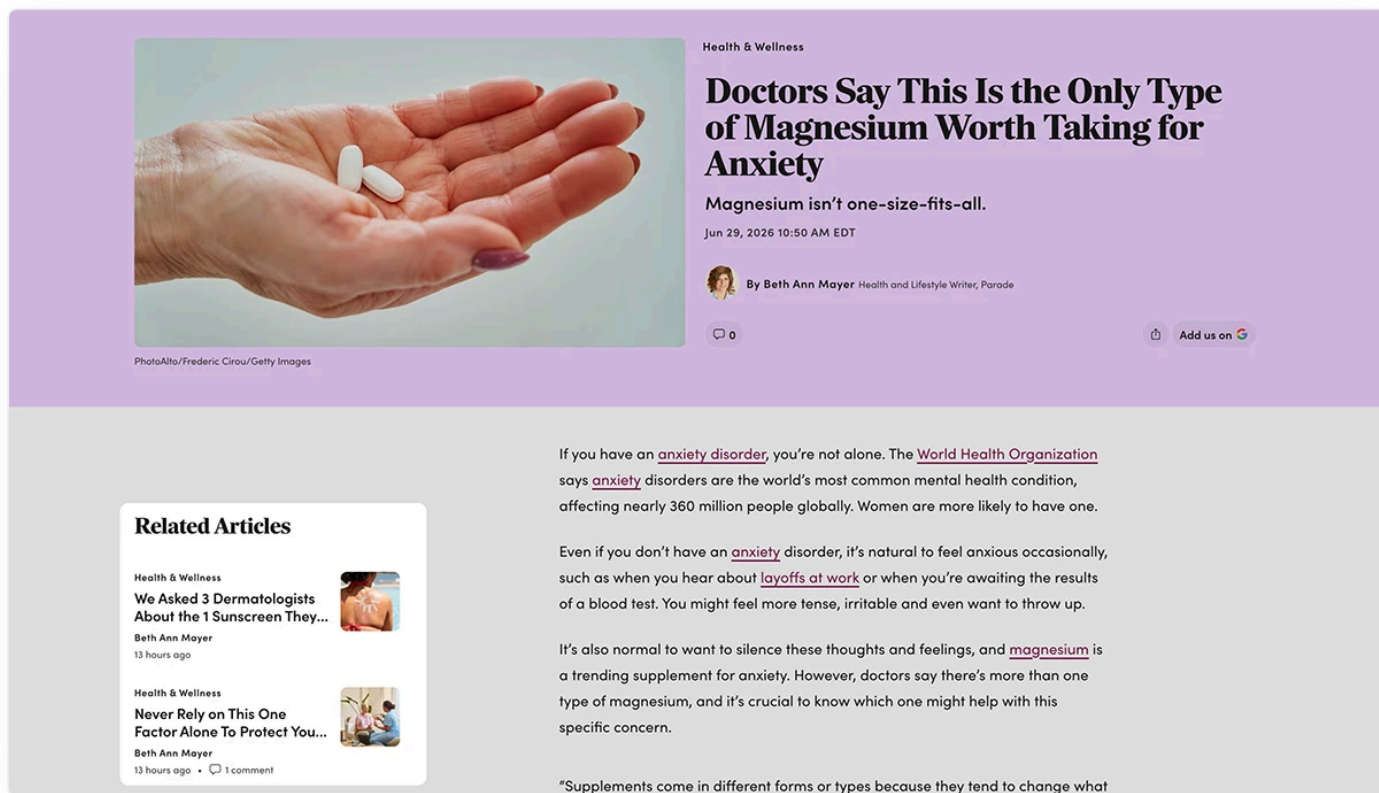
With how accessible development is these days, I like to think most people reading this won't need my help to find value in the following ideas.

#2

The Arena Group is using AI-powered content recommendations to add millions in revenue

As one of the "16 companies dominating Google", I've been following the progress of The Arena Group's content sites for years.

When I learned they were using AI to recommend content to readers to keep them on sites like *Parade* and *The Street*, I had to read more.



The screenshot shows a web article on a purple background. The main headline is "Doctors Say This Is the Only Type of Magnesium Worth Taking for Anxiety" in bold black text. Below it, a sub-headline reads "Magnesium isn't one-size-fits-all." and the date "Jun 29, 2026 10:50 AM EDT" is displayed. The author is "By Beth Ann Mayer Health and Lifestyle Writer, Parade". To the left of the text is a photo of a hand holding two white pills. Below the photo is the caption "PhotoAlto/Frederic Cirou/Getty Images". In the bottom left corner, there is a "Related Articles" section with two items: "We Asked 3 Dermatologists About the 1 Sunscreen They..." and "Never Rely on This One Factor Alone To Protect You...". To the right of the main text, there is a paragraph of text about anxiety disorders and magnesium, followed by a quote: "Supplements come in different forms or types because they tend to change what".

As Digiday shared, their goal for 2026 is to increase pageviews per visitor from an average of 1.1 to 2.

Their AI-powered recommendations have already increased average pageviews from 1.1 to 1.2, which at their scale equates to several million dollars in additional revenue.

Unfortunately the Digiday report didn't say exactly where these recommendations happen (I've reached out for comment), but I did notice something slightly out of the norm that you might find interesting.

Whereas on most sites recommended articles are at the end of the one you're reading, on Parade they're prominently shown in their left sidebar.

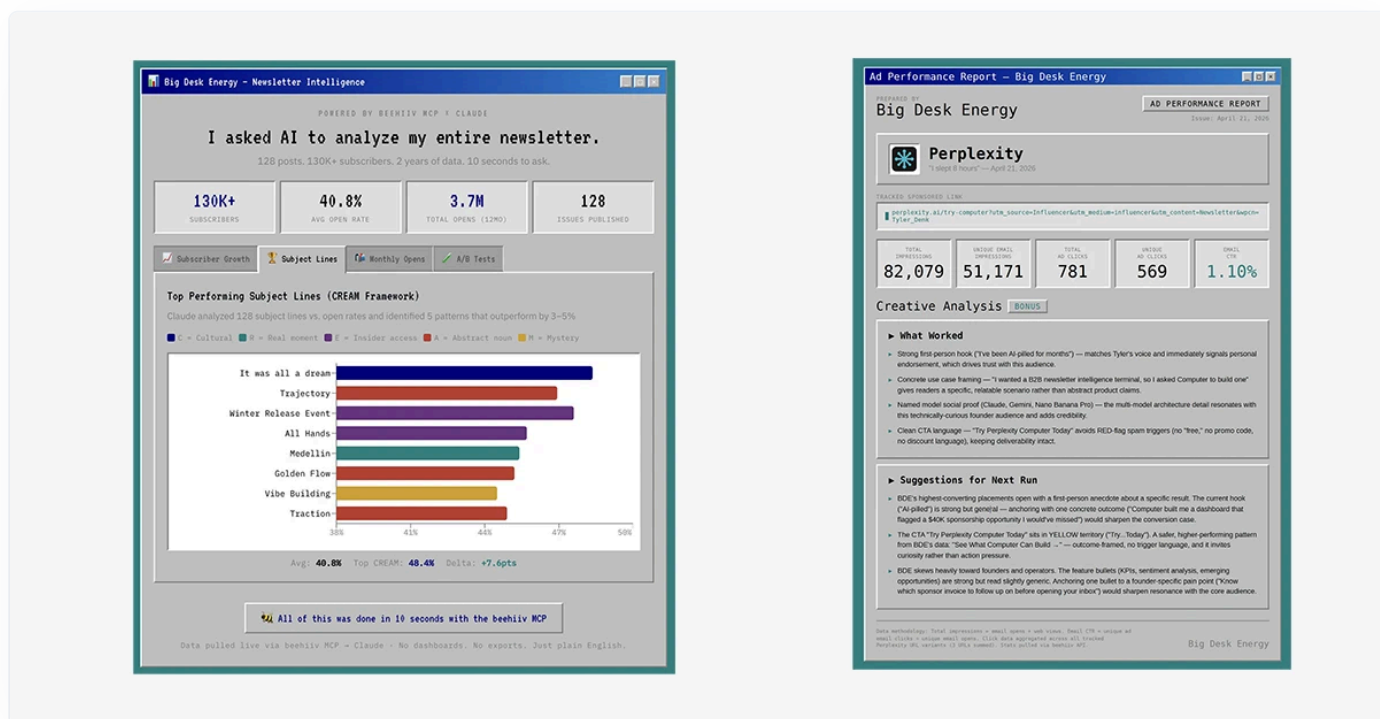
I expected some might take you to other brands in their network, but it seems the recommendations are doing a good enough job without that.

#3

Beehiiv CEO Tyler Denk automated the workflow behind his 130,000+ reader newsletter

The CEO of newsletter platform beehiiv, which recently crossed \$30M in ARR, revealed 5 AI-assisted workflows behind his personal newsletter.

The end result is that it went from taking him over 4 hours to manage each week to just a few minutes.



The AI-assisted workflow in action

The five-step workflow is as follows:

1. Claude helped build a **style guide** based on all past newsletters, against which all new rough drafts are checked and updated
2. It creates a **subject line** based on the best open rates from past editions
3. **Ad copy** is updated to match the framing that previously resulted in more ad clicks
4. Claude then creates a **weekly, customized performance report** to send to relevant sponsors
5. **New subscribers** are scored for whether they might be interested in advertising on the newsletter in the future

While I'm an active user of a prominent beehiiv competitor (Kit) I'm enjoying his personalized updates enough that it makes me more bullish on the product itself.

1800Flowers.com lets AI decide which products show up first, and conversions are improving

In the second quarter of 2026, gifting platform 1-800-Flowers completed the implementation of AI-powered sorting and ranking on its site.

CEO Adolfo Villagomez stressed the importance of having the right products above the fold (before a user has to scroll), as that's where most sales come from.

The screenshot shows the 1800Flowers.com website interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with the logo, a search bar, and links for Sign In, My Orders, and (0) Cart. Below this is a secondary navigation bar with categories: Summer, Birthday, Sympathy, Occasions, Flowers, Plants, Food & Keepsakes, Same-Day Delivery, Sale, Community, and Corporate Gifts. A green banner across the page reads "The Countdown to July 4th has Begun!" with a "Learn More" button. The main content area is titled "Birthday Flowers and Bouquets for Every Celebration". On the left, there's a search filter sidebar with a "FIND AVAILABLE PRODUCTS!" section, a "169 results" count, and filter options for "Delivery Option" (Shipped in a Gift Box, Local Shop Delivery) and "Price Range". The main product display shows three featured bouquets: "Floral Embrace™" (starting at \$54.99), "Celebrate The Day™ Bouquet" (starting at \$54.99), and "Daydream Bouquet™" (starting at \$59.99). Each bouquet is shown with a vibrant image of flowers in a vase or box.

Since the move to having AI select those items, conversions are said to be improving.

He also made another comment about how AI is helping the business,



Most importantly, we are also finding out what customers really want and what they are willing to pay, not only from a type of spend, but also from delivery method and delivery fees they are willing to pay.

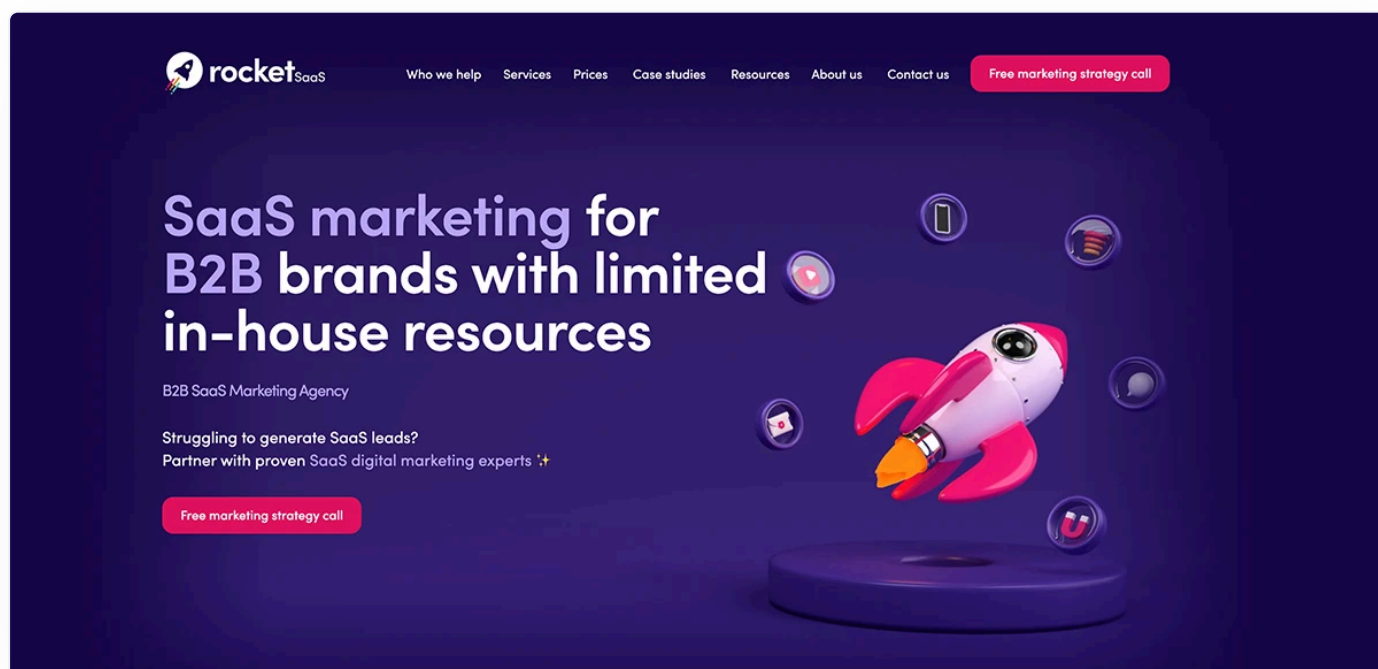
It sounds like they're also using AI to find the sweet spot between conversion rates and revenue per order by testing different shipping and pricing options.

Split-tests in themselves aren't a new thing, but having AI make more of the decisions is an interesting approach.

#5 As RocketSaaS hits \$7M in ARR, its founder shares how he uses AI

RocketSaaS CEO Ryan James recently shared where he has both embraced and rejected AI in his business.

His agency, which helps software-as-a-service companies with their marketing, recently hit \$7M in ARR.



Ryan said the likes of client strategies, relationships, and briefs are all human-first.

Places he's embraced AI include:

- Market research with AI call analysis
- Scaled content repurposing
- AI analyzing ad performance
- AI data enrichment for tighter ICP

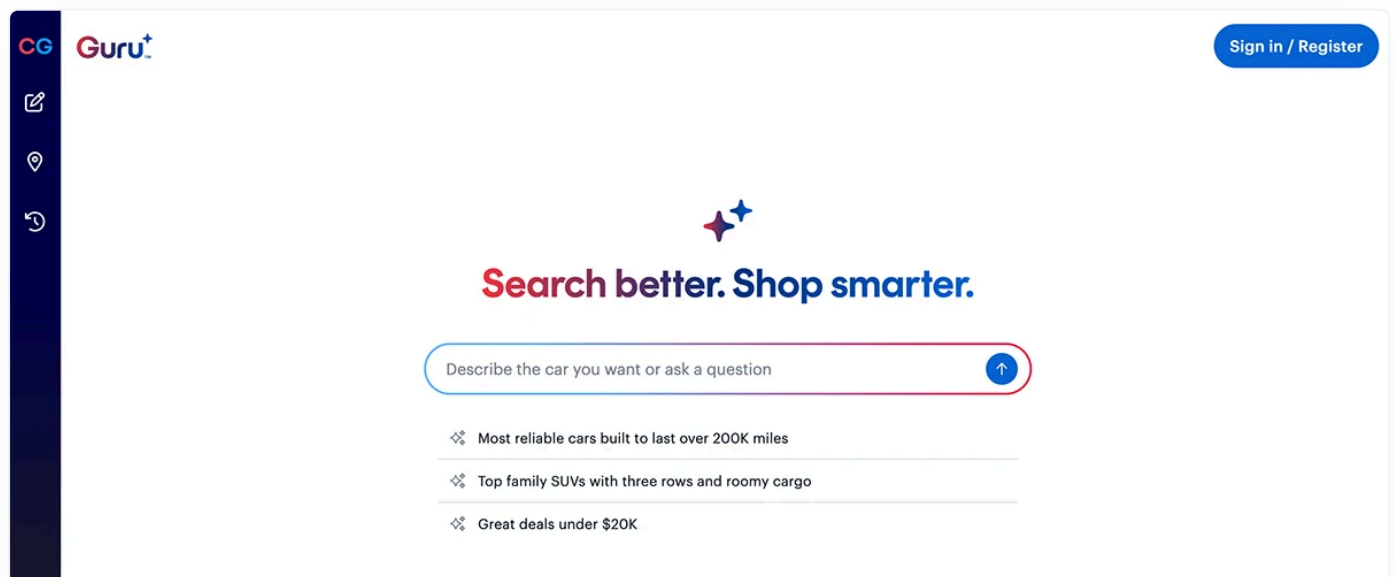
As I've previously shared on the Ahrefs blog, I like the idea of using AI to monitor calls (where allowed) and customer support tickets, then using those as inspiration for prompts to monitor your AI visibility.

It was just one of many angles I shared, but it's a great way to home in on the natural language and terminology people use in your space.

#6

CarGurus' AI-powered search users spend 4.4x more time on their site

In their February 2026 earnings call, CarGurus CEO Jason Trevisan shared some numbers about the success of their generative AI search experience, CG Discover.



Discover was described as a "decisioning copilot" that answers consumer requests using its live marketplace inventory and automotive expertise.

As shown in the image above, customers can use natural language to navigate their marketplace, rather than predefined filters.

Trevisan revealed that Discover traffic for the quarter grew 3.5x, with attributable leads growing 10x.

He also shared that Discover users spend 4.4x as much time on the site as regular visitors.

#7

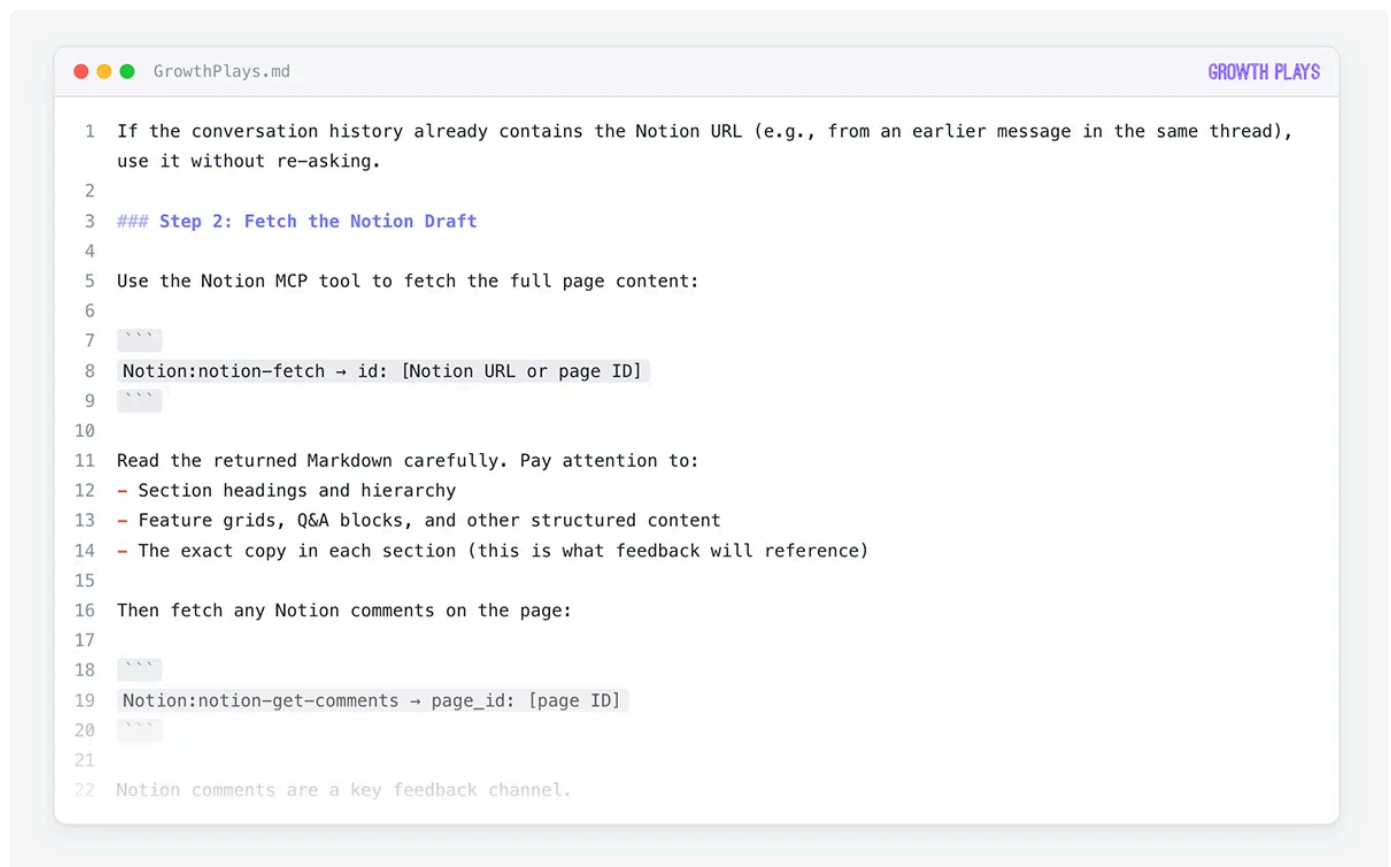
The owner of B2B SEO Agency Growth Plays shared how he uses Skills to follow client guidelines

I've been following John-Henry Scherck online for as long as I can remember.

As someone who stopped working with clients at the start of 2024, he keeps me in the loop with a new perspective on the challenges (and opportunities) agency owners face.

He recently shared that account managers at his agency, Growth Plays, use skill files and an MCP to ensure their work always adheres to client feedback.

Here's a sample of the skill file to see how it is structured:

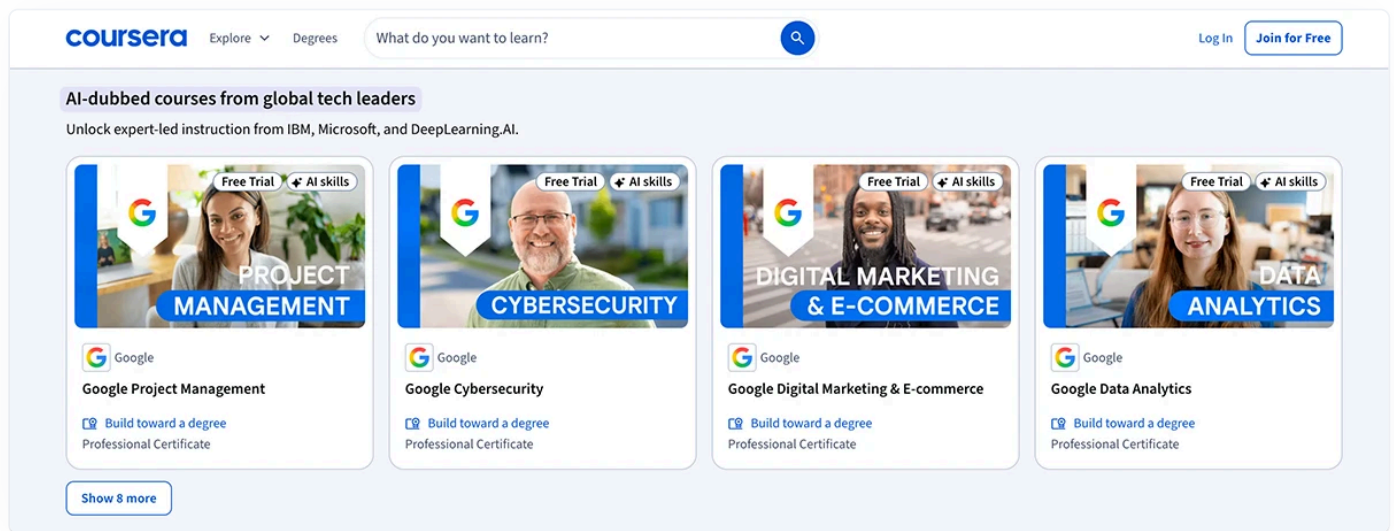
A screenshot of a code editor window titled "GrowthPlays.md" with a "GROWTH PLAYS" logo in the top right corner. The editor contains a skill file with 22 lines of text. Line 1 is a conditional instruction about Notion URLs. Line 3 is a section header "### Step 2: Fetch the Notion Draft". Line 5 is an instruction to use the Notion MCP tool. Lines 7-9 show a code block for "Notion:notion-fetch" with a placeholder for a Notion URL or page ID. Line 11 is an instruction to read the returned Markdown carefully. Lines 12-15 are a list of things to pay attention to: section headings, feature grids/Q&A blocks, and exact copy. Line 16 is an instruction to fetch Notion comments. Lines 18-20 show a code block for "Notion:notion-get-comments" with a placeholder for a page ID. Line 22 is a concluding statement about Notion comments as a feedback channel.

```
1 If the conversation history already contains the Notion URL (e.g., from an earlier message in the same thread),
  use it without re-asking.
2
3 ### Step 2: Fetch the Notion Draft
4
5 Use the Notion MCP tool to fetch the full page content:
6
7 ```
8 Notion:notion-fetch → id: [Notion URL or page ID]
9 ```
10
11 Read the returned Markdown carefully. Pay attention to:
12 - Section headings and hierarchy
13 - Feature grids, Q&A blocks, and other structured content
14 - The exact copy in each section (this is what feedback will reference)
15
16 Then fetch any Notion comments on the page:
17
18 ```
19 Notion:notion-get-comments → page_id: [page ID]
20 ```
21
22 Notion comments are a key feedback channel.
```

In one section, when comparing a live article vs a content draft in Notion, they look for things like sections the client removed, added content not part of their drafts, and any structural or layout changes.

It's a smart way to ensure they learn from each piece of content they put together.

Coursera's AI dubbing has already been used by 120,000 learners



AI-dubbed courses available on Coursera

Coursera, the online learning platform, introduced AI dubbing across more than 100 courses.

If you're unfamiliar with the term, this means users see the same video, but the speaker's voice is translated into other languages.

When early stats were shared in 2025, Coursera revealed that more than 120,000 users had used the feature.

Users said it improved their focus and understanding, likely by not having to rely on subtitles or studying in a non-native language.

While I've tested translated *captions* in my courses before, dubbing seems worth trying on a small scale before potentially rolling it out further.

#9

Duolingo says AI helped them increase course output by 10x in just two years



The Duolingo language-learning dashboard

Luis von Ahn, the co-founder of the language-learning platform Duolingo, said last month that "AI has fundamentally changed what's possible for us."

And he has the numbers to back it up.

In Q1 of 2026, the company published 20,500 course units. That's 10x as many as they were publishing per quarter just two years ago.

Even with the huge growth in output, he believes Duolingo is just scratching the surface of what AI will make possible for them.

One aspect other employees noted is that AI will enable Duolingo to personalize lessons for each user, making the time spent on the platform feel much more like a private session with a tutor.

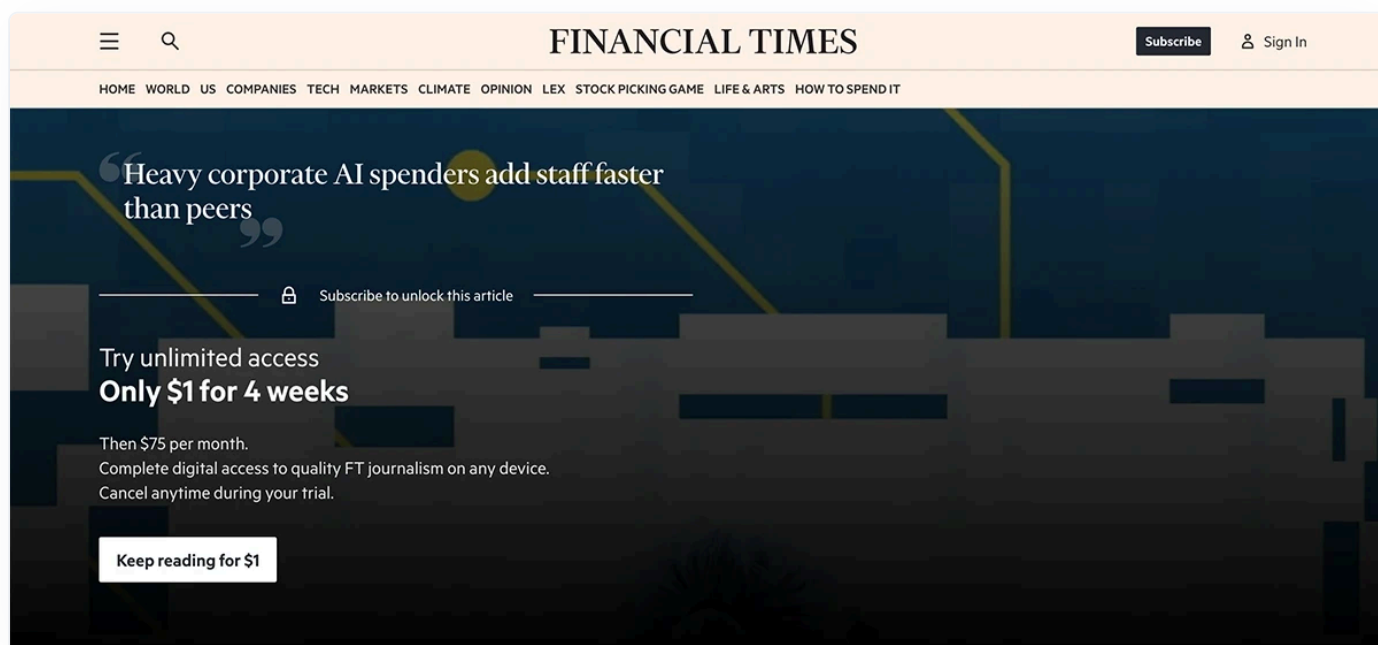
#10

The Financial Times saw a 36% (then 290%) conversion rate increase thanks to AI personalization

Financial Times' Adriana Whiteley told Press Gazette that when they originally tested personalized paywalls, they saw conversion rates increase by 36%.

Now, after a more sophisticated comparison of the implementation, personalization showed a 290% increase in conversion rate.

The personalized messaging that users see is chosen by AI, but not written by AI.



SIDENOTE. To be transparent, it was not immediately clear where this personalization occurs. I couldn't get the messaging in the screenshot to change, so I *assume* it's there to get users to commit after subscribing to a \$1 trial.

Whiteley made it clear that AI is part of the creation process, but humans are responsible for the content.

#11 How I use the Ahrefs API to find content & PR opportunities on autopilot

Over the past few years I've built dozens of tools that make my marketing work both more efficient and more effective.

I plan to create a full report on those one day, but for now let me share one of my favorites: A custom dashboard that shows the overall search traffic, AI visibility, newly acquired links (and more) of the brands I want to monitor.

It's all powered by the Ahrefs API.

(Yes, I'm biased, but I've been an Ahrefs customer for 10+ years. Now API access has opened up, I'm building a lot of things with it.)

Company	Top links (last 3 months)			DR distribution	Last cost	Status
	54	crunch.id		May 19, 2026	0 x DR70+ 0 x DR60+ 1 x DR50+	50 units OK
	97	wordpress.org		May 8, 2026	50 x DR70+ 0 x DR60+ 0 x DR50+	650 units OK
	97	github.com		Apr 9, 2026	0 x DR50+	
	96	shopify.com		Apr 9, 2026		
	94	medium.com		Mar 19, 2026		
	94	forbes.com		Apr 2, 2026		
	View all 50					
	84	featurebase.app		May 4, 2026	11 x DR70+ 6 x DR60+ 5 x DR50+	308 units OK
	82	framer.app		May 15, 2026		
	80	hostadvice.com		May 9, 2026		
	80	mailmodo.com		Apr 20, 2026		
	76	respona.com		Jun 7, 2026		
	View all 22					
	97	wordpress.org		Apr 19, 2026	50 x DR70+ 0 x DR60+ 0 x DR50+	700 units OK
	97	github.com		Apr 9, 2026		
	94	github.io		May 27, 2026		
	94	medium.com		Mar 29, 2026		
	94	forbes.com		Mar 20, 2026		
	View all 50					
	97	github.com		Apr 26, 2026	23 x DR70+ 10 x DR60+ 6 x DR50+	546 units OK
	94	medium.com		Mar 30, 2026		
	83	wpengine.com		Apr 4, 2026		
				Apr 15, 2026		

Even on an Ahrefs Lite plan, you get enough units each month to track dozens of sites in the same way (or hundreds by only focusing on specific metrics).

While I've always been fairly technical and designed and built 95% of my own websites, without AI I never would have attempted to put a dashboard like this together.

I've written a full guide to using the backlinks API for content & PR insights, which can easily be adapted to look at other stats.

#12

In just 8 months, one Fortune journalist has written 600+ stories with the help of AI

The Wall Street Journal's Isabella Simonetti wrote a great article (note: it's behind a paywall) on the prolific writing of Fortune journalist Nick Lichtenberg.

Lichtenberg, who rejoined Fortune in July of 2025, uses both Perplexity and Google's Notebook LM to help create article drafts based on the headlines he comes up with.

Search

FORTUNE

Subscribe

Sign in

Home

Latest

Fortune 500

Finance

Tech

Leadership

Lifestyle

Rankings

Multimedia



Nick Lichtenberg

Nick Lichtenberg is Business Editor at Fortune, responsible for reporting and editing a mix of breaking news and digital features. This includes stories developed with the assistance of artificial intelligence, filed under Fortune Intelligence, as well as commentary submissions and book excerpts. Nick was formerly *Fortune's* executive editor of global news. Prior to *Fortune*, he was a deputy editor at Business Insider covering the economy, wealth, and real estate, and a breaking news editor at Bloomberg covering corporate news and equities markets.

in



ECONOMY

The central bank of central banks just released its flagship annual report – and it sees a \$1 trillion AI investment boom headed for a reckoning

AI

The most reassuring argument about AI and jobs quietly explains why Gen Z can't get one

By Nick Lichtenberg
June 29, 2026

REAL ESTATE

Harvard's housing report has a darker message than affordability –the middle-class home was always a historical accident

By Nick Lichtenberg

Most Popular

SUCCESS

Elon Musk on MacKenzie Scott giving away \$26 billion of her fortune: 'Sadly,' it makes the world a worse place

By Sydney Lake
June 29, 2026



SUCCESS

Lichtenberg then adds his own insight to the stories, such as in one example where he used a phone conversation with a Wall Street executive to make the piece his own.

It was said that he thinks of himself as an "AI alchemist", which is such a good term I had to check if the .com was available. Sadly not.

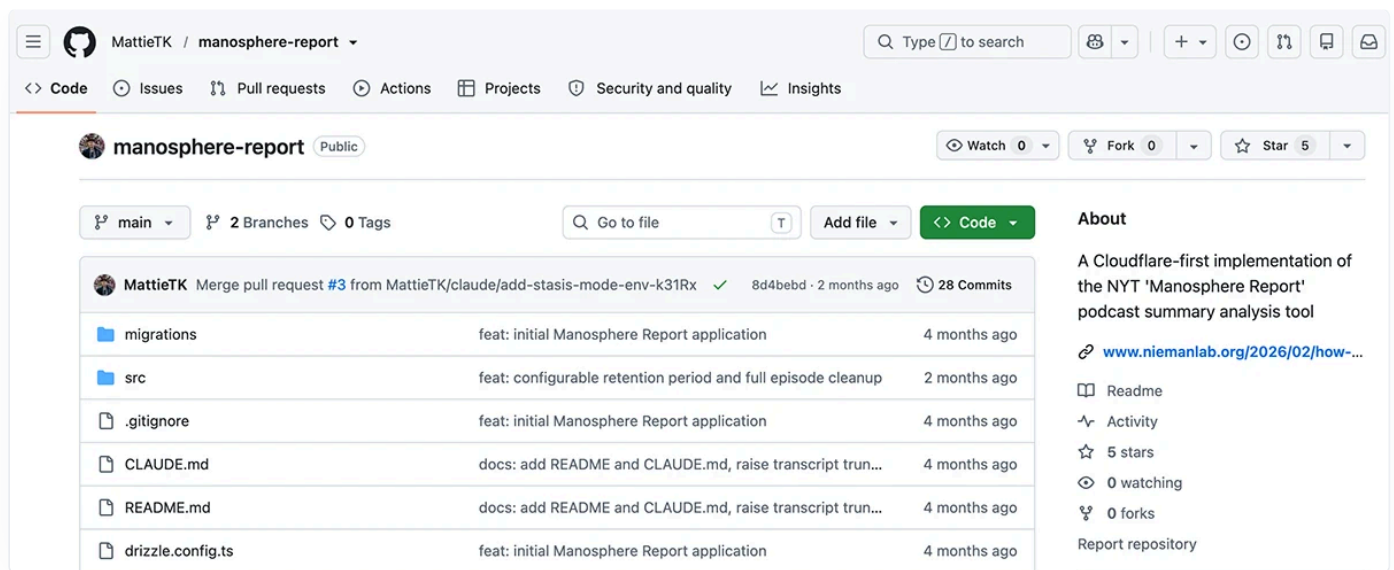
While the SEOs reading will understandably be concerned about the potential impact of such a reliance on AI, it sounds like he can add genuine value to the work, and he stated AI often helps with documents or transcripts where the facts are right there.

#13

The New York Times uses AI to transcribe and summarize podcasts to monitor market sentiment

The New York Times' Zach Seward told Nieman Lab the publisher uses LLMs to transcribe and summarize episodes from dozens of podcasts, then compiles them into what it internally calls the "Manosphere Report".

Each morning, a summary of the previous day's commentary is emailed to nearly 40 journalists.



Cloudflare's Matt Taylor shared how this might work, but it's important to note that it's not the original

The report shared how it's helping to provide fast, clear signals about how influencers are reacting to certain government policy changes, and more.

Because of its success, they're now looking into other categories where this monitoring process makes sense to implement.

The initiative is seen internally as a way to amplify their investigative prowess, rather than actually having AI create new content itself.

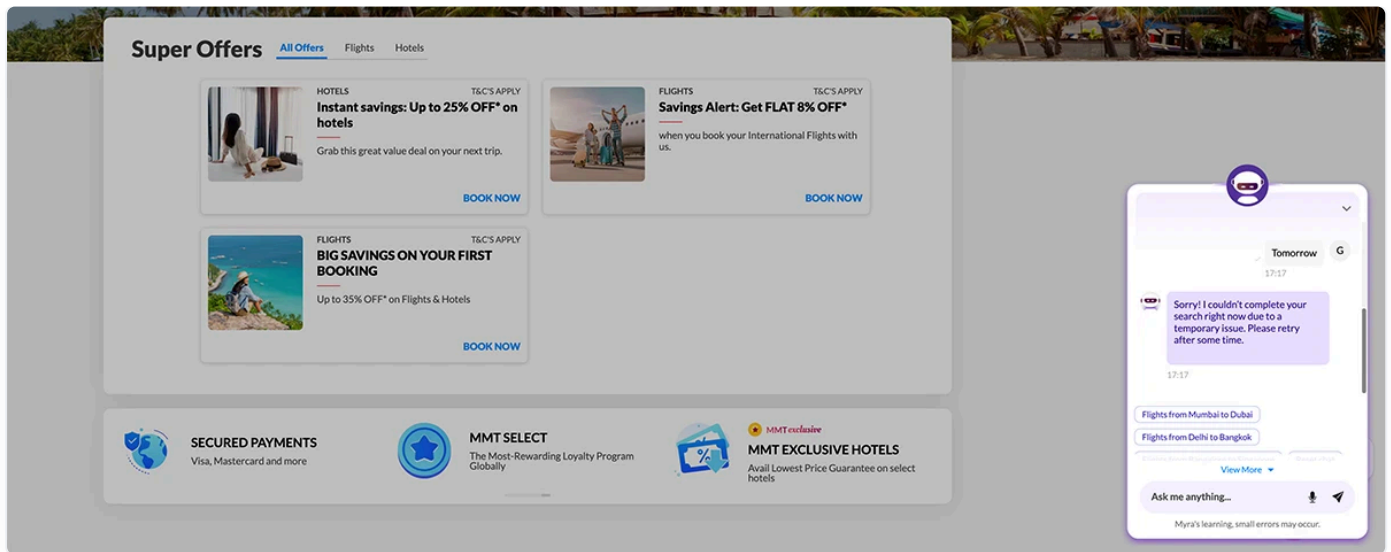
#14

MakeMyTrip's AI Assistant Myra handles 80,000 conversations daily (and is boosting conversions)

Just last month, travel platform MakeMyTrip revealed that its AI assistant, Myra, is handling more than 80,000 conversations per day.

That's an increase from 50,000 conversations daily in the prior quarter.

Co-founder and CEO Rajesh Magow said that users who interact with Myra across discovery, support, and booking stages have a 10% higher conversion rate than those using "*traditional filter-led journeys*."



I didn't have much luck with the assistant personally, but maybe it was a one-off

Myra is available to all site visitors and can assist with specific flights you're looking to book or with any general questions.

In my own testing, it's clear Myra still has some kinks to work out.

After choosing a flight, Myra asked me for dates to choose from, but the only options to click on were other flight destinations. When I suggested traveling tomorrow, Myra said it was having a temporary issue.

#15

Publisher Mediahuis is experimenting with a 7-agent workflow for news reporting

Press Gazette's Charlotte Tobitt recently shared details on Mediahuis' new AI workflow, set to be used by their 2,000 journalists.



Our brands



Region ▼

Category ▼

Irish Independent

Sunday Independent

De Telegraaf

N
Nieuwsblad

nrc

Irish Independent
News brands

Sunday Independent
News brands

De Telegraaf
News brands

Nieuwsblad
News brands

NRC
News brands

Belfast
Telegraph

Aachener Zeitung

GAZET VAN ANTWERPEN

HBVL

CRIME
WORLD

The company, which publishes around 25 titles across Europe, plans to use the following process:

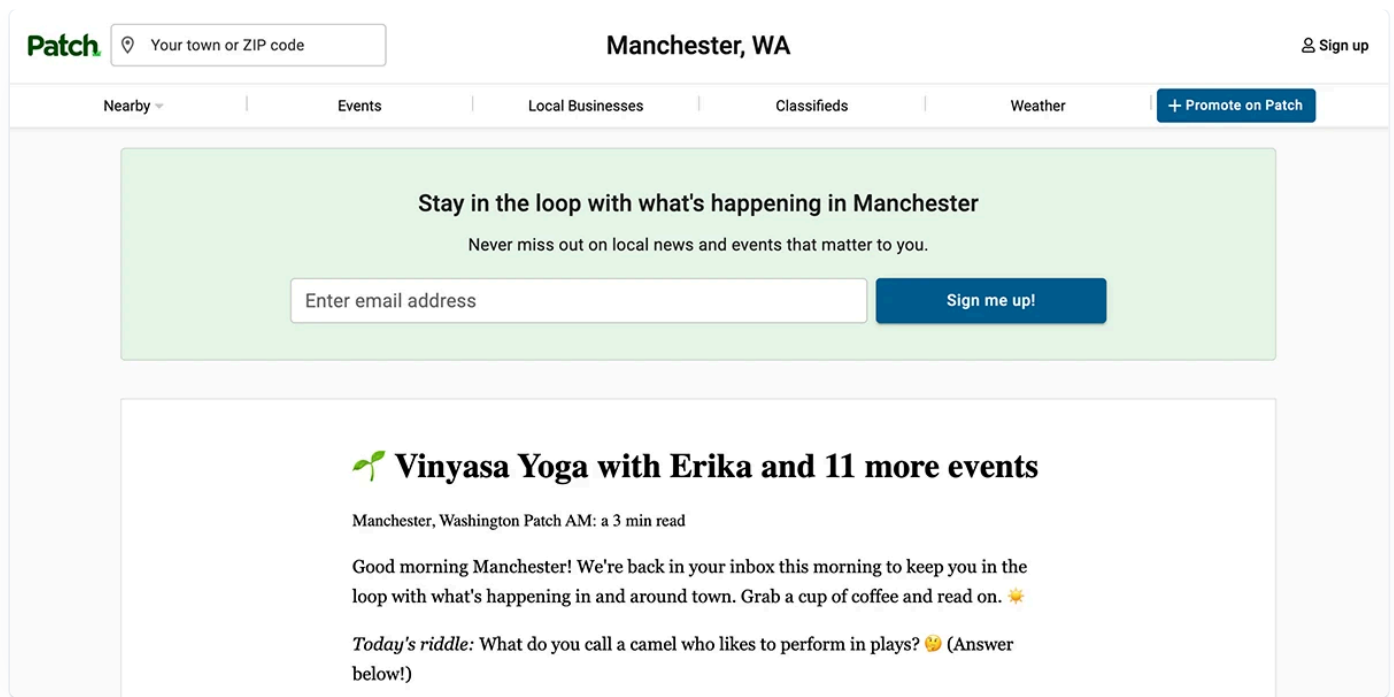
- Agent #1: Ingests and scores events in real time
- Agent #2: Selects stories based on factors like historical performance
- Agent #3: Creates a 300-400 word story
- Agent #4: Finds relevant images and videos to include
- Agent #5: Ensures legal compliance
- Agent #6: Fact-checks the story
- Agent #7: Follows the news and updates the content if additional information emerges

If this is interesting, I recommend reading the full story, which includes additional quotes and insights.

#16

Patch's AI-curated newsletters have almost 1M subscribers

Patch, which covers local news for hyperlocal communities, now has nearly one million subscribers to its AI-curated newsletters.



An example PatchAM newsletter, targeted at locals in Manchester, Washington

Dubbed *PatchAM*, it's especially valuable in areas with few to no local news alternatives.

AI's job is to sift through relevant sources, such as Nextdoor and school newspapers, to find stories worth sharing.

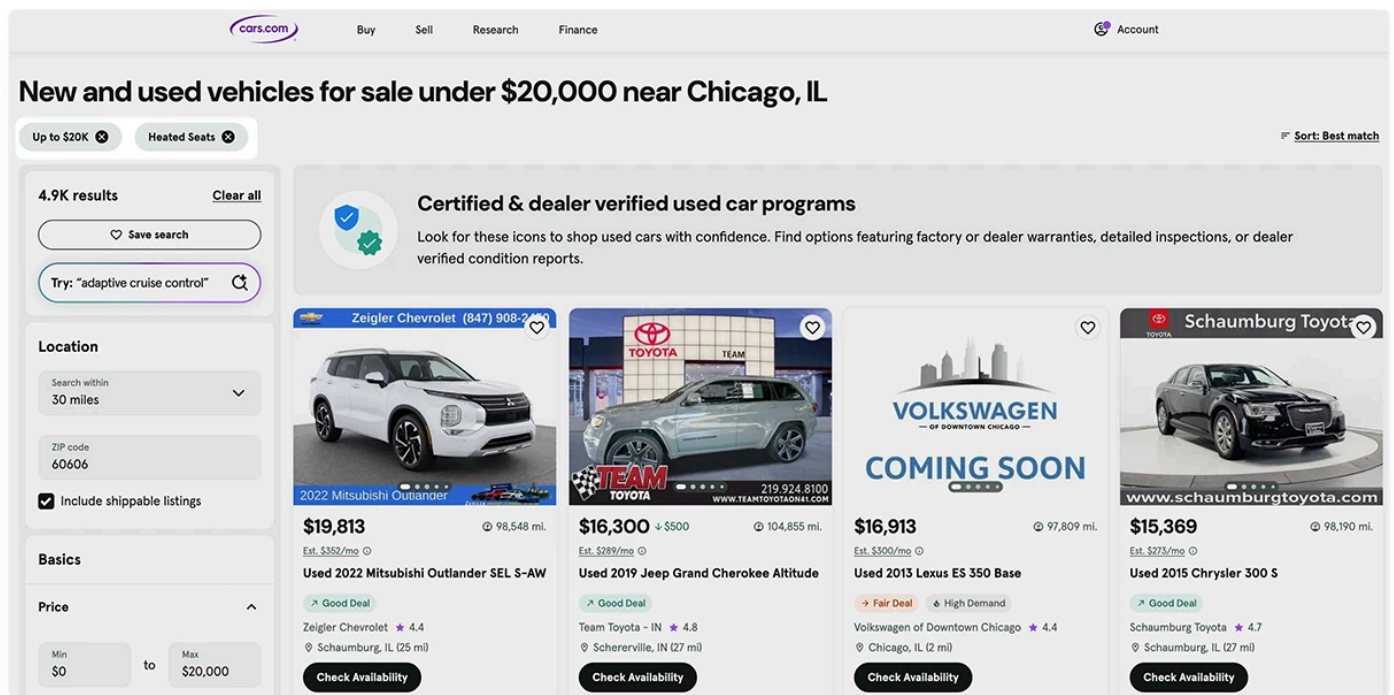
They state that the AI is constantly trained to make sure only "the most relevant, trustworthy news" is sent out. These newsletters are then monetized with advertising, featuring companies such as T-Mobile.

As CEO Warren St. John shared with CJR, "This is not the high church of journalism. This is about creating a foothold in a relationship and meeting a need".

#17

Cars.com's AI-powered search, Carson, is converting users at a nearly 30% higher rate

In an investor update at the end of 2025, Cars.com revealed the conversion increases they're seeing from their AI-powered search assistant, *Carson*.



I searched "cars with heated seats under \$20,000" and the relevant filters were automatically applied

Specifically, they shared that:

- Carson assists with ~15% of web and mobile searches on the site
- Customers using Carson [return to the site 2x more than other shoppers](#)
- Carson users save 3x more vehicles
- They convert at a nearly 30% higher rate from search results to vehicle detail pages.

Carson supports more natural searches, such as "*good first car for a teen driver*" and "*cars with heated seats under \$20,000*".

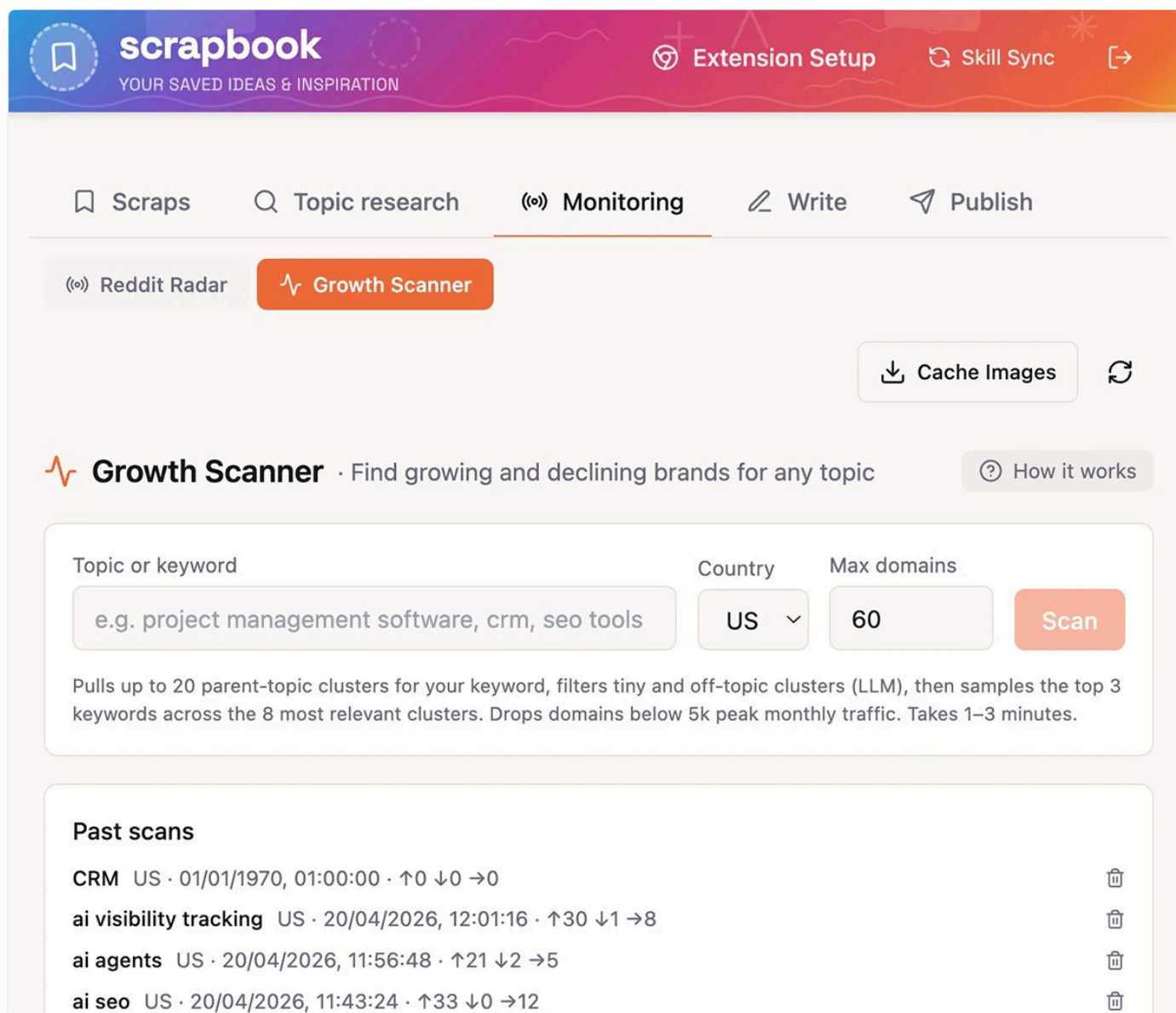
One really nice touch is that it automatically applies traditional filters relevant to your initial query, so you don't *have* to use Carson for follow-up questions.

#18

Louise Linehan built a tool to find trending keywords right as they're taking off

The Ahrefs blog team recently ran a hackathon where everyone was encouraged to automate whatever part of their role they "find most painful."

Using Letaido, an Ahrefs-owned platform, Louise Linehan built a tool to help her identify trending topics worth writing about.



She initially provided seed topics, then set the system to run daily to find anything new.

Her custom dashboard shows how those terms have trended over the past 3, 6, and 12 months. It also checks whether Ahrefs already ranks for the phrase (in which case it's generally better to ignore the term or update the existing article).

While the idea of finding trending keywords isn't new, having a private dashboard check for you daily — without needing any programming skills — is a great testament to what's now possible.

#19

QuickBooks uses AI to tailor their onboarding process to the business category you're in

Speaking at the 54th Nasdaq & Jefferies Investor Conference, Intuit CFO Sandeep Aujla shared insights into what AI is now enabling for the QuickBooks brand.

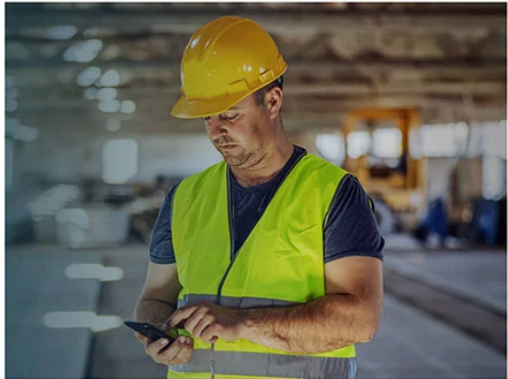
During the onboarding process, as soon as QuickBooks learns what type of business you're in, it can tailor the following steps specifically to your business.

Business Type ▾Products & Features ▾Accountants & Bookkeepers ▾Plans & PricingTalk to us: 0808 168 9533 ▾Resources ▾Sign in

Accounting Software for Construction Companies

Take control of your business finances with QuickBooks Online accounting software for construction businesses.* Get a complete view of each project—track job costs, manage finances, and access powerful business insights—all in one place.

*Not available for the QuickBooks Self-Employed product.

[Explore plans & pricing](#)

One example they gave was that of plumbers.

Because they've already served tens of thousands of plumbers, they know what KPIs matter to that customer and can highlight them prominently.

The key insight is that it makes QuickBooks feel like it was built specifically for them.

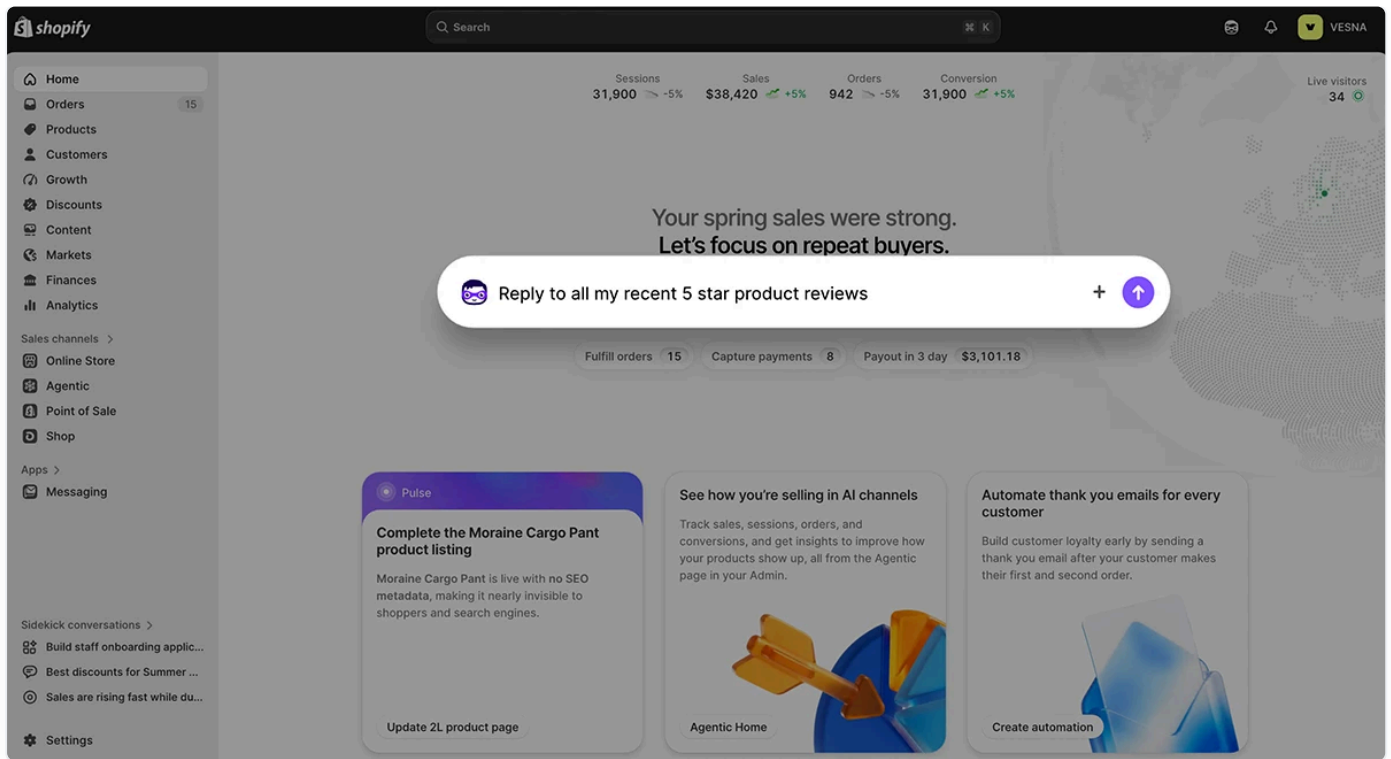
I see a lot of potential here for other SaaS businesses to follow suit.

#20

Shopify's Sidekick is not just a chatbot. Users created 12,000 apps with it in a single quarter

If you've logged into a Shopify account recently, you'll have no doubt seen the company's AI assistant, Sidekick, front and center.

Everything points to users finding it valuable, with the number of weekly active shops using Sidekick up 4X year over year.



Shopify also revealed that over 12,000 custom apps were created with Sidekick in Q1 of 2026.

They added that Sidekick was used to generate almost half of all Shopify flows, and it's responsible for "multimillions" of theme edits — up 1,000% in a single quarter.

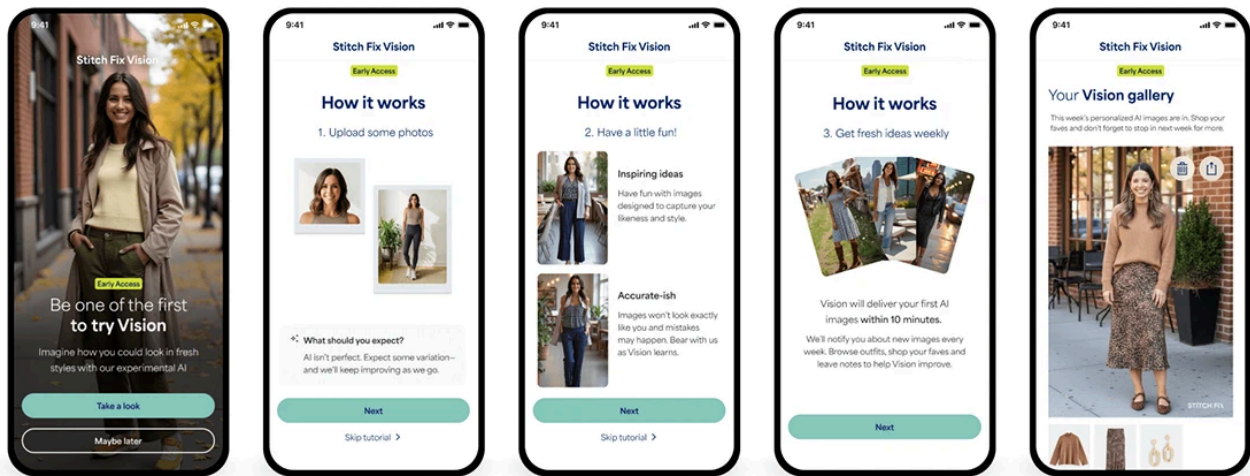
It's hard not to imagine that the more users can achieve with the platform they're already on, the less likely they are to look for a competing solution.

#21

Stitch Fix saw a 100% lift in spend from its AI-powered "see it on me" feature

In October 2025, online styling service Stitch Fix introduced Vision, a feature that lets customers see how an outfit might look before they click *Buy*.

In June of 2026, Stitch Fix announced plans to roll it out to more customers, as the initial release had been such a huge success.



Over 90 days, customers who used Vision's "see it on me" functionality generated more than a 100% lift in Freestyle spend.

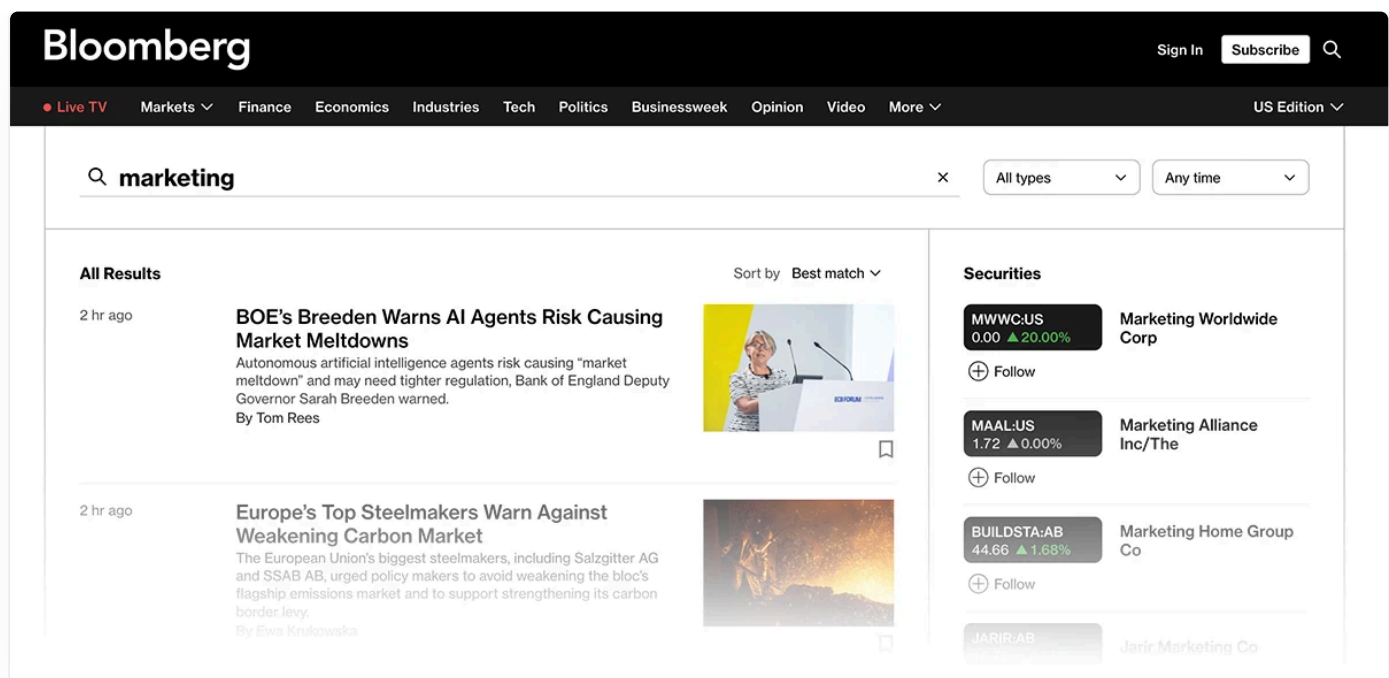
(*Freestyle* is different in that it allows customers to choose their own items, rather than those that have been curated for them.)

CEO Matt Baer says Stitch Fix has access to billions of data points about customers, such as budgets and style preferences, which help improve its AI-powered features.

#22

Thanks to AI-powered search, Bloomberg saw news CTR on mobile nearly double

Bloomberg Media CTO William Anderson recently shared behind-the-scenes updates on how the company's new search functionality has impacted user journeys.



SIDENOTE . While my graphic represents Bloomberg.com, it's possible this functionality was enabled elsewhere or only on certain devices. I reached out to William a couple of days ago to get clarity.

Specifically, they found:

- 15% CTR increase just from AI-powered relevance improvements
- 15% improvement in the average clicked position
- A 21% drop in "load more" clicks
- News CTR on mobile went from 22.7% to 43.9%
- Subscribers now make 2.9x more searches

Bloomberg was methodical about their approach, with a simple goal to get readers to the right story, quickly. As Anderson put it,



We rebuilt search with AI at its core — hybrid semantic and keyword matching, a modular redesign, a mobile-native overhaul across web and app. Shipped over six months through disciplined, compounding experimentation.

Testing it for myself, it's interesting how search functionality is happy to pull up *much* older content (I saw results from 2012) if it thinks it's the best fit.

I personally didn't find the matching to be very accurate, even with more specific searches than the one in my graphic above, but it sounds like the overall results are hard to dismiss.

#23

The Financial Times uses AI to tag archived content and better understand user interests

There was another fascinating insight from a previously mentioned Press Gazette article I had to share: The Financial Times uses AI to tag archival content to better understand what people are reading.

Adriana Whitely, director at FT Strategies, mentioned that AI is really good at labeling content — something journalists generally prefer not to do.

As Whitely put it:



..you can test different types of biases and different types of niche content or people, and you can do quite a lot more analysis to be able to identify those clusters and causes of your attraction.

Reading between the lines, I presume the tagging goes far beyond which category an article belongs to, but also covers any biases or strong opinions it might hold.

As I don't have their data (and it feels weird to mock up tagging their content), here's how the layers of tagging for articles on Ahrefs might look.

ARCHIVE INTELLIGENCE					
AI Content Tagging					
412 articles analysed					
#	ARTICLE	EMOTION	TOPICS	AUDIENCE	AI CONFIDENCE
01	Keeping Data-Driven Content Fresh Was a Monthly Slog. So We Taught an Agent to Do It. CONTENT MARKETING	Analytical	Content Refresh AI Agents	Content Teams	93
02	Average Organic Traffic Benchmarks From Real Websites (June 2026) DATA & STUDIES	Analytical	Traffic Data Benchmarks	SEO Strategists	95
03	What is a Good Organic CTR? Real Website Benchmarks (June 2026) DATA & STUDIES	Curious	CTR Benchmarks	SEO Strategists	90
04	What is an AI Agent? A Plain-English Guide GENERAL MARKETING	Optimistic	AI Agents Explainer	Marketers	84
05	10 SEO Trends I've Seen Firsthand in 2026 (With Data) AI SEARCH	Optimistic	SEO Trends Forecasting	SEO Strategists	88
06	We Analyzed 137K Sites: 97% of Ilms.txt Files Never Get Read AI SEARCH	Cautious	Ilms.txt AI Crawlers	Technical SEOs	92
07	How I Use My AI Marketing Assistant After 200+ Hours AI SEARCH	Curious	AI Assistants Workflows	Marketers	81
08	Agentic Marketing: What's the Big Deal and How to Get Started	Optimistic	Agentic Marketing	Marketers	85

How different layers of tagging might look across individual articles

This work wouldn't be very useful on a site like Detailed, where we have fewer than ~200 pieces of content, but when you're publishing more than that *daily*, it makes a lot more sense.

#24

Ahrefs' Ryan Law has a 23-skill-file process to help with Content Engineering

```
Content-Engineering.md ahrefs

1 # Format for Publish Skill
2
3 Transform a finished draft into a WordPress-ready document with Ahrefs shortcodes, then export to .docx format.
4
5 ## Input
6
7 **Draft file path** - Path to a cited draft file (e.g., `./content-pipeline/6-drafts-cited/pinterest-seo.md`)
8
9 ## Dependencies
10
11 **pandoc** is required for .docx export. Install via Homebrew:
12
13 ```
14 brew install pandoc
15 ```
16
17 If pandoc is not installed, the skill will save the formatted .md file and note that manual conversion is
  needed.
18
19
```

I've learned a lot from Ahrefs' Director of Content Marketing since I joined the company, and he even unknowingly inspired me to move Detailed to *Astro*, which I'm currently working on.

Ryan does not believe AI is a great fit for all content. Nor does he believe in using AI to *scale* content creation.

That said, he does see opportunities for it to help in certain workflows, which he recently covered in detail.

It's a topic a lot of people are interested in.

23 skill files make up his entire process, with each step reviewable before moving on to the next.

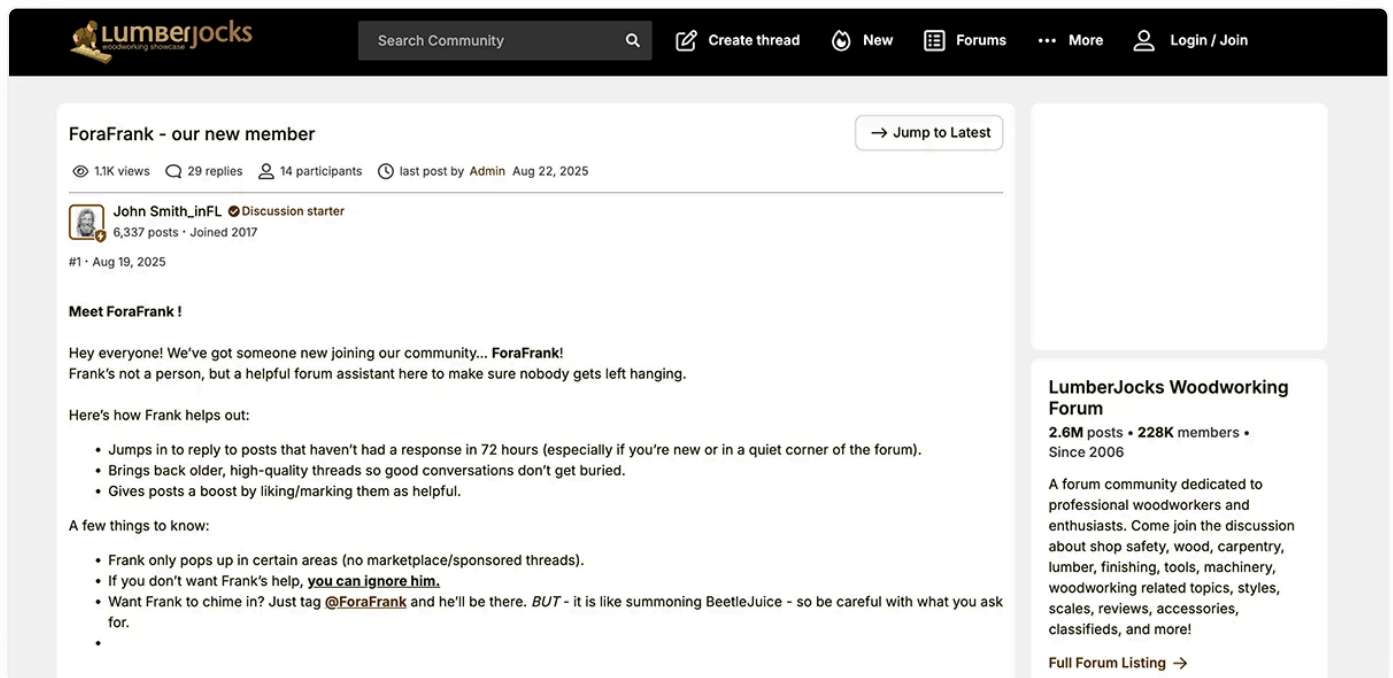
#25

This AI-powered forum assistant increased posting rates for new users by 40%

VerticalScope is one of my favorite public companies to follow, as they're in the fairly unique position of being behind over 1,000 online discussion forums.

In 2025 they rolled out their AI-powered community assistant, Fora Frank.

When making posts in a community, users can tag @ForaFrank to get specific insights, much like how people might tag @grok on X (Twitter).



As revealed by CEO Chris Goodridge, "we're seeing close to a 40% increase in posting rates for new users when they're received or apply from Fora Frank."

You can see ForaFrank being introduced to a community in the picture above.

Goodridge noted they're excited about the results and are exploring additional ways to use it to improve the quality of discussions on their sites.

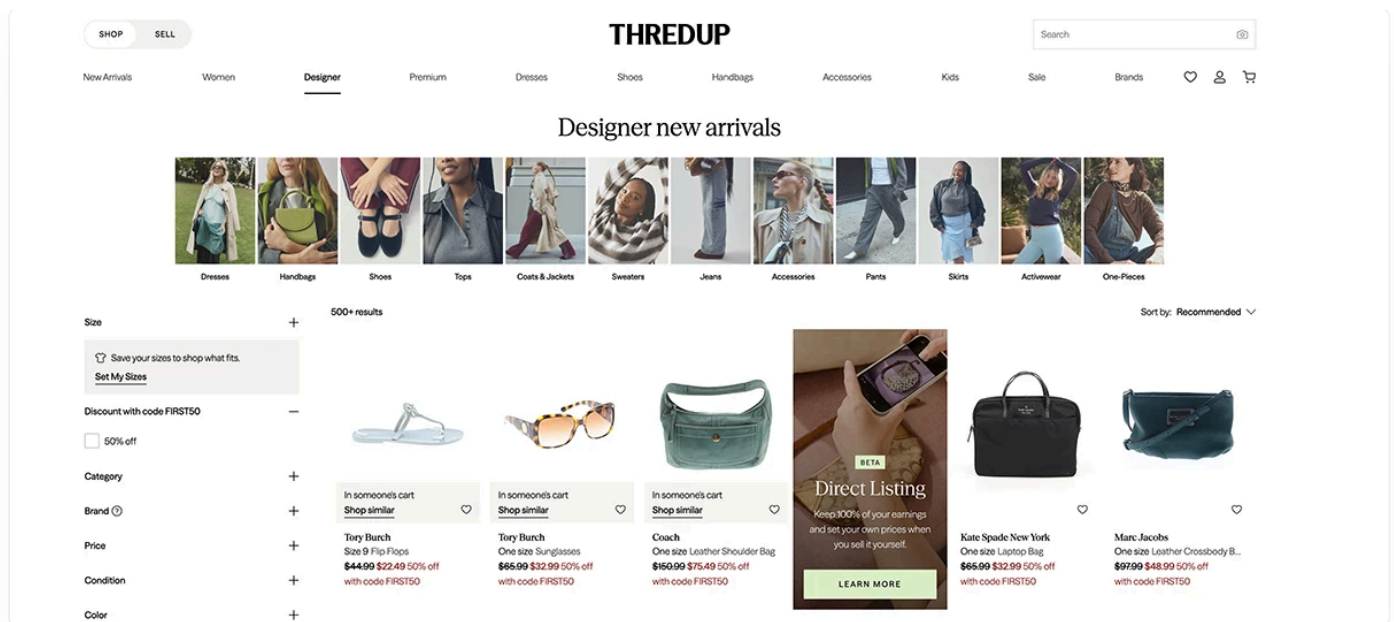
#26

ThredUp added AI-generated images to ~100K product pages

ThredUp, the online marketplace for secondhand clothes, added AI-generated images to over 100,000 product pages on its site.

CEO and co-founder James Reinhart said the AI model images had a "modest conversion impact" on existing customers.

For those new to purchasing secondhand items, however, he said the satisfaction it had generated has been "on par with our very best features".



I found lots of AI-generated image examples on Reddit, but none through clicking around myself

Online searches reveal criticism of the feature, with customers saying the AI-generated images sometimes alter the items' actual design.

Other comments by Reinhart clarified that they have further improvements to their quality before rolling the images out further, which *suggests* they aren't going away.

#27

TIME launched an AI agent on its site. 7 months later, it still greets users on every article

In late 2025, TIME shared details about its goals with its new agent, TIME AI.

The aim was to increase users' engagement with the site, while appealing to new audiences who prefer to consume content in multiple ways.

Welcome to TIME AI BETA

Explore 102 years of TIME's journalism

Try  summarizing an article ,  translating an article ,
 reading an article out loud , or  asking about a recent topic

Try these prompts for inspiration:

Outline TIME's coverage of social media

Show me how TIME has reported on social media across the decades, then summarize how the coverage has evolved, then make English and Mandarin audio versions.

Debate AI's impact on humanity

Create a debate for and against the question "Is AI good for humanity?" using TIME's reporting and opinion archives, and include supporting examples from different years.

Recap interviews with Donald Trump

Make a five-minute audio briefing summarizing Donald Trump's most recent interviews with TIME, highlighting his key themes and quotes.

Summarize Lee Jae Myung's profile

Summarize TIME's recent profile of President Lee Jae Myung, and create Korean and English audio versions.

The four key features the agent aims to help with are:

1. Summarizing articles
2. Translating articles
3. Reading articles out loud
4. Letting users ask about recent topics

While I unfortunately don't have any information on how it's performing so far, it's encouraging that 7 months later, the feature is still prominently placed on every single article on their site.

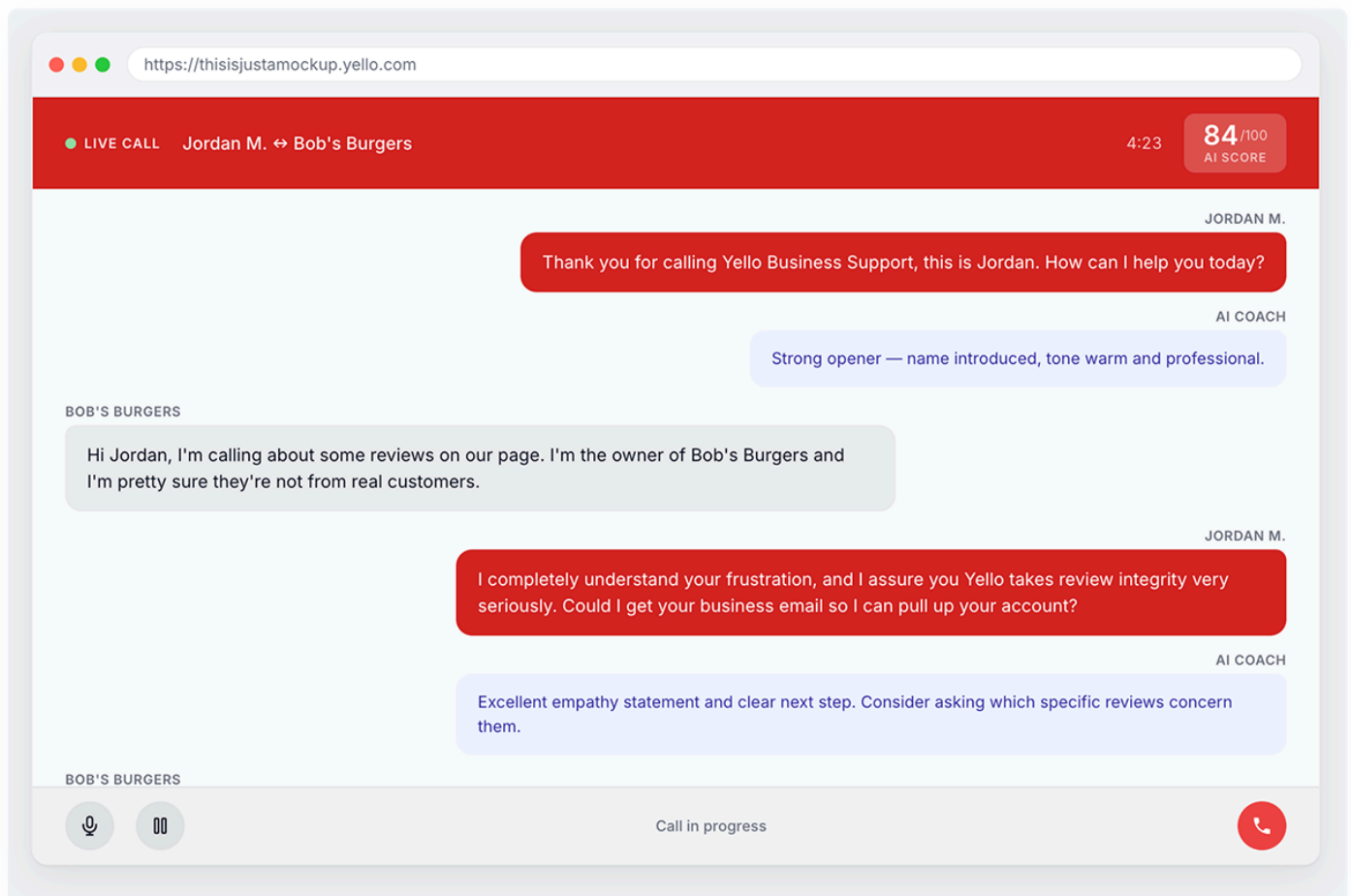
SIDENOTE . It may be that they have a contract with the tech provider (Scale AI) to keep it in place, but given it was their third launch together, it suggests they're happy with how things are going.

It seems to be quite strict about what it allows you to discuss, even if TIME has previously written about that topic, but with a bit of prodding, you can usually get what you were looking for.

Yelp has reported success with real-time AI coaching for sales reps and managers

Yelp CEO David Schwarzbach recently revealed the company has built internal tools to help coach its sales reps.

AI can listen and provide insights in real time, or right after a call, regarding which Schwarzbach added, "We're having real success with that."



This is just a mockup to help illustrate what *might* be happening

Another benefit is that managers can gain insights into how conversations are going, which they can then use to improve the feedback they pass on.

While this isn't relevant to the line of work I'm personally involved in, I can see the benefit of getting that immediate feedback to improve the calls team members are having.

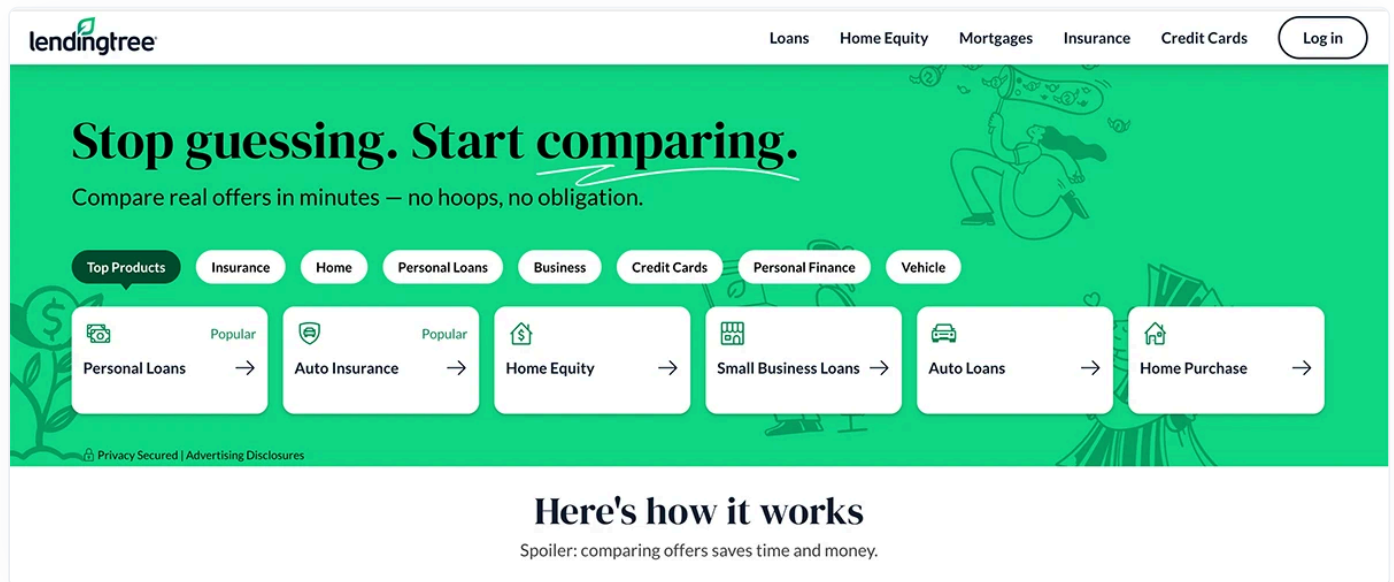
#29

Using AI for design, ad, and funnel testing, LendingTree increased conversions 17%

LendingTree, the publicly listed online lending marketplace, revealed that its AI use case primarily focuses on improving conversions.

In March of 2026 they revealed that their AI-enabled technology, used by their marketing team, increased their overall conversions by 17% year-over-year.

While they didn't reveal any specifics about the changes, there may be some insights in their recently redesigned homepage.



Launched in Q1 2026, they said they've been pleasantly surprised by the conversion uplift it has driven.

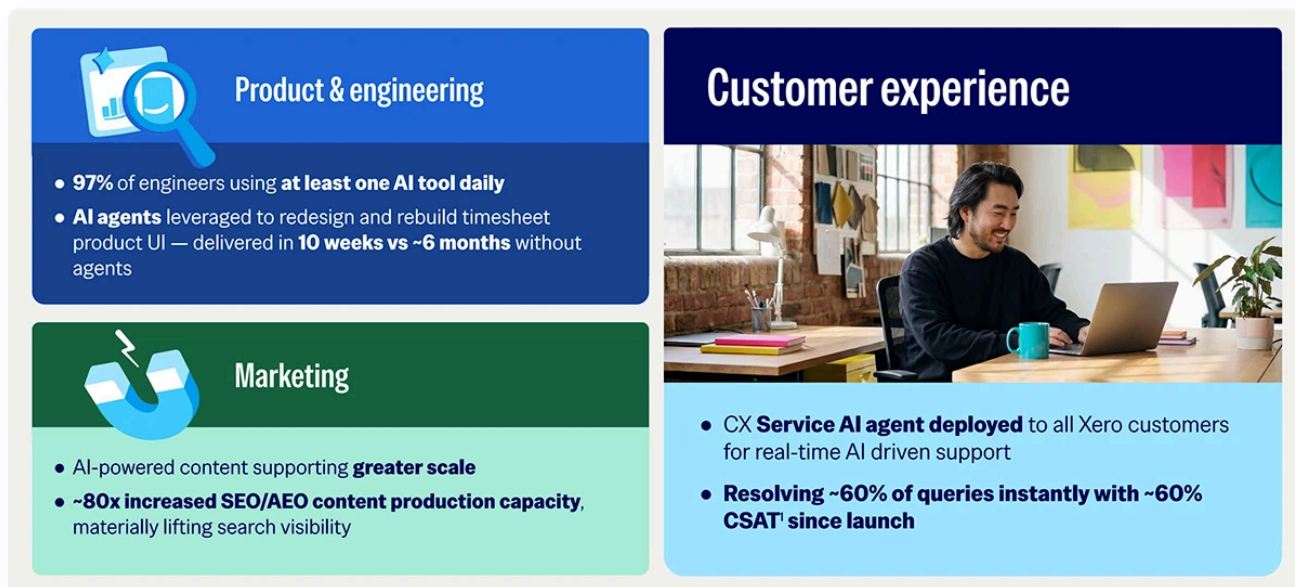
The change? They transitioned from *"an SEO/lead-gen-oriented homepage to a branded one with valuable consumer information."*

#30

Xero's AI content engine took its output from 60 articles per quarter to 50 per day

Xero CEO Sukhinder Cassidy recently revealed that the company's AI-powered content engine has increased their output by around 80x.

It enabled Xero to scale *"from roughly 60 SEO content pieces per quarter to 50 pieces per day"*. She added the approach has *"lifted U.S. search visibility from minimal exposure to good to great."*



It should be noted that edits to existing articles likely account for a significant share of these increases.

It's not my place to comment on what Xero is doing, especially as I can only speculate which articles were written or edited in this way.

That said, anyone considering scaling content with AI would be wise to consult a professional before getting started.

You made it this far! If you would like to see a second edition, I would love your thoughts

Thank you for making it to the end of a report I've wanted to write for a very long time.

I think there's the potential to put together a new edition a few times each year, but I first need to make sure there's enough interest.

(I truly enjoyed writing it, but it takes a bit more time than I would like to admit.)

I always feel awkward about asking, but any shares, comments, or 'Likes' on LinkedIn and X would be much appreciated.

I have a few other reports in the works, so stay tuned for some updates there.

Thank you!

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 TWITTER

 LINKEDIN

 BUFFER

Written by **Glen Allsopp**, the founder of Detailed, which is now (very proudly) an Ahrefs company. You may know me as 'ViperChill' if you've been in internet marketing for a while. We're behind the Detailed SEO Extension for Chrome & Firefox, which currently has 600,000 weekly users. Clicking the + button tells us what you enjoy reading. Social sharing is appreciated (and always noticed). You can also follow me on Twitter and LinkedIn.

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I'm excited to share that I now work at [Ahrefs](#), a bootstrapped, \$100M+ ARR marketing platform where I've been a customer (and fanboy) for 10+ years.



I'm primarily working on marketing strategy and research, with a focus on SEO and AI search.

I love to get involved in product updates, where I'm creating new marketing skills, apps and workflows for the Ahrefs-owned [Letaido](#).

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